

Singer of Life

Text: From a Texcoco Nahuatl poem

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is written on three systems of a single staff in treble clef, with a key signature of two flats (Bb and Eb) and a 3/2 time signature. The melody consists of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing rests. Above the staff, Roman numerals indicate the pitch: 'vi' (F4) appears at the start of each system, and 'ii' (D5) appears in the middle of the first two systems. The lyrics are provided in two parts, numbered 1 and 2, with line breaks corresponding to the musical phrasing. The first system ends with a fermata over the final note. The second system includes a fermata over a note in the second line. The third system ends with a double bar line.

vi ii vi

1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write.
2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky.

vi ii vi

Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright.
E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die.

vi ii vi

Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light!
Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.